INFO 1100: Introduction to Programming

Summer 2026 — Information Science

Instructor:	Rebecca M. M. Hicke (rmh327@cornell.edu)
When:	Lectures — T/W/Th (11:30am–12:25pm; sync or async)
	Individual meetings — M/F (scheduled with instructor)
Where:	`https://tinyurl.com/info1100-su26`
Office Hours:	T (10:30am–11:30am, 2:00pm–3:00pm) /
	W (10:00am–11:00am, 4:00pm–5:00pm) /
	Th (9:00am–10:00am, 2:00pm–3:00pm)
	[Book here]
Class Website:	`https://canvas.cornell.edu/courses/87705`

Introduction

Welcome to INFO 1100: Introduction to Programming! I'm so excited you're here, and I'm looking forward to spending this summer with each of you. Although summer courses are intense (we're fitting fifteen weeks of content into six!), they're not meant to feel impossible; my goal is that each student leaves this class with an understanding of programming fundamentals and the confidence to go learn more either independently or in future classes. Although portions of this class are taught asynchronously, I am here as a resource that you should take advantage of if you're struggling, curious, excited, or just want to talk — I am teaching this course because I genuinely love programming, and love *teaching* programming. I hope this will be a great semester for all!

Course Description

An introduction to programming taught in Python. Emphasizes practical code design skills and data processing. Topics will include functions, conditionals, loops, basic data structures, and writing to and from files. In addition to writing code, the class will focus on skills critical to AI-enabled development, such as writing specifications, reading code, and reflecting on design choices. Students will be prepared to take further programming-intensive INFO classes.

Course Objectives

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

- Explain and apply foundational programming skills, including: variables + types, conditionals, functions, for + while loops, lists, dictionaries, class + objects
- Design + implement simple data processing programs in Python
- Utilize and analyze AI chatbots as programming assistants

Texts

All texts used in this course are freely available online. Sections of the following texts will be assigned:

- *Think Python: How to Think Like a Computer Scientist* (3rd Edition) by Allen B. Downey
- *Python Like You Mean It* by Ryan Soklaski
- *Python Data Science Handbook* by Jake VanderPlas
- *Data Visualization: A Practical Introduction* by Kieran Healy

Course Structure

Tuesdays through Thursdays of each week will be devoted to lecture. These are expected to be about 20–40 minutes each, although the exact length will be subject to change based on the material covered. The lectures will be delivered over the course Zoom during the scheduled class hours (11:30am–12:25pm). They can be attended synchronously and this is highly recommended — you'll get a lot from being able to interact with me and other students live, ask questions, and more. Lectures will also be recorded and can be watched asynchronously. A reading and set of guided reading questions will be due before lecture each day and a short lab will be assigned for completion after each lecture.

The first Monday will be a synchronous introduction to the course and myself; this is the only class where synchronous attendance will be required. On each of the remaining Mondays, students will schedule a 15 minute meeting with me to go over the weekly assignments. Similarly, students will meet with me on each of the first five Fridays for a quick oral quiz on that week's material. The last Friday of term will be open for questions and consultation about final projects.

Grading

Grades will be assigned according to the following percentages:

Category	**Value**
Participation	10%
Labs + GRQs	25%
Assignments	25%
Quizzes	25%
Final Project	15%

Labs and GRQs will be graded based on completion. Participation points will come from the biweekly meetings with the instructor. Assignments will be graded partially based on completed materials and partially via oral assessments.

Three slip days will be allowed for late submissions of work. Each of these days allows you to submit your work up to 24 hours after the established deadline. These days can be used successively for the same assignment (e.g. to submit an assignment two days late) or separately for different assignments. If you run out of slip days, late work will not accepted. Note that because this is a summer course, it will move at a very fast pace; falling behind on material may make it difficult to recover.

Letter grades will be given on the following criteria:

Letter Grade	**Range**
A+	97% – 100%
A	94% – <97%
A-	90% – <94%
B+	87% – <90%
B	84% – <87%
B-	80% – <84%
C+	77% – <80%
C	74% – <77%
C-	70% – <74%
D+	67% – <70%
D	64% – <67%
D-	60% – <64%
F	<60%

Course Schedule

Schedule may be subject to change.

	Date	Topic	Assignments Due
Week 1	Mon. 06/22	Introduction	
	Tues. 06/23	Types + Expressions	Read Chapter 1 + GRQs
	Wed. 06/24	Variables + Statements	Read Chapter 2 + GRQs
	Thurs. 06/25	Strings	Read Sections 8.1–8.3, 8.5 + GRQs
	Fri. 06/26	***Quiz 1***	
Week 2	Mon. 06/29	Assessment: *Assignment 1*	Assignment 1
	Tues. 06/30	Conditionals	Read Sections 5.1–5.7 + GRQs
	Wed. 07/01	Functions	Read Sections 3.1–3.3, 3.8–3.9, 6.1–6.3 + GRQs
	Thurs. 07/02	Lists	Read Sections 9.1–9.6, 9.8–9.11 + GRQs
	Fri. 07/03	***Quiz 2***	
Week 3	Mon. 07/06	Assessment: *Assignment 2*	Assignment 2
	Tues. 07/07	For + While Loops	Read Sections 3.4, 7.1, 7.5-7.6, 9.7, For-Loops and While-Loops + GRQs
	Wed. 07/08	Recursion	Read Sections 5.8–5.10, 6.6–6.9 + GRQs
	Thurs. 07/09	Dictionaries	Read Sections 10.1–10.7 + GRQs
	Fri. 07/10	***Quiz 3***	Midterm Survey
Week 4	Mon. 07/13	Assessment: *Assignment 3*	Assignment 3
	Tues. 07/14	Regular Expressions	Read Sections 8.8–8.9 + GRQs
	Wed. 07/15	Tuples + Sets	Read Sections 11.1–11.4, 18.1 + GRQs
	Thurs. 07/16	Classes + Objects (Part 1)	Read Sections 14.1–14.4, Defining a New Class of Object, Object Identity and Creating an Instance + GRQs
	Fri. 07/17	***Quiz 4***	
Week 5	Mon. 07/20	Assessment: *Assignment 4*	Assignment 4

	Date	Topic	Assignments Due
	Tues. 07/21	Classes + Objects (Part 2)	Read Chapter 15, Defining Instance-Level Attributes, Methods + GRQs
	Wed. 07/22	Multidimensional Data with NumPy	Read Introducing the ND-array, Accessing Data Along Multiple Dimensions in an Array, Basic Array Attributes, Functions for Creating NumPy Arrays, "Vectorized" Operations: Optimized Computations on NumPy Arrays + GRQs
	Thurs. 07/23	Reading + Writing Files	Read Sections 7.2, 8.6, 13.1–13.2, Working with Files + GRQs
	Fri. 07/24	***Quiz 5***	
Week 6	Mon. 07/27	Assessment: *Final Project Proposal*	Final Project Proposal
	Tues. 07/28	Dataframes	Read Introducing Pandas Objects, Data Indexing and Selection, Operating on Data in Pandas + GRQs
	Wed. 07/29	Data Visualization (Principles)	Read Look at Data + GRQs
	Thurs. 07/30	Data Visualization (in Python)	Read Matplotlib + GRQs
	Fri. 07/31	Final Project Check-In	
Finals	Tues. 08/04	Final Project Assessments	Final Project, End-of-Term Survey

Feedback

I welcome your feedback on this course so that I can make the experience better for you and all students. I'm always happy to discuss concerns face-to-face or over email, or this link will take you to an anonymous survey, available all term, that will allow you to give me feedback at any point in the semester.

AI Policy

Some assignments will explicitly request that you use an AI chatbot. For all other work, you are expected to complete it without using any AI assistance. Failure to follow this policy will result in an F for the assignment and may result in additional consequences.

Accessibility

Your health and well-being are ultimately the most important thing. There are a number of campus services available to you if needed, some of which can be found on this page.

I encourage students with any form of accessibility needs to contact and register with Student Disability Services, who will work with both of us to arrange necessary accommodations. More information about SDS is available on their website or you can email them at sds_cu@cornell.edu. After you've registered with SDS, be sure to follow up with me so we can implement any accommodations!

Inclusion

All students deserve to be treated with respect by their fellow classmates and course staff. Respect involves acknowledging each person's ideas, ensuring that everyone feels welcome in class environments, and recognizing every individual as an equal member of the learning community. Harassment, intentional or not, is any behavior that undermines this standard of respect. Any violation of this expectation will not be tolerated. If you encounter any form of harassment or want to talk about your experience in the course, please visit me during office hours or reach out via email. The university also offers support services and reporting channels for issues such as sexual harassment and other forms of bias, many of which are listed on the Title IX Support and Resources page.

Acknowledgments

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